
WORD rsidR COLORIZER

User's Guide

For Forensic Examiners and Investigators

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Table of Contents

1. Introduction	3
1.1 What This Tool Does	3
1.2 Investigational Value.....	3
2. Recommended Workflow	3
3. The Application Interface.....	4
3.1 Opening a Document.....	4
3.2 The rsidR Values Pane (Left Side).....	4
3.3 The Document Preview (Right Side).....	4
4. Colorizing rsidR Values	4
4.1 Applying Color	4
4.2 Producing Multiple Colorized Versions.....	5
5. Saving and Logs	5
5.1 Saving a Colorized Document	5
5.2 The Colorization Log.....	5
6. Generating an RSID Report	6
7. Best Practices & Limitations	6

1. Introduction

1.1 What This Tool Does

Microsoft Word stamps content with revision save identifiers (RSIDs). Each time a document is opened and edited, Word generates an RSID value and tags the runs, paragraphs, and text that were created or modified during that editing session. Text typed in the same session generally shares the same rsidR value.

The Word rsidR Colorizer reads these identifiers out of a .docx file and lets you assign a color to any rsidR value. The text associated with that value is then displayed and saved in that color, making it visually obvious which portions of a document trace back to the same editing session.

1.2 Investigational Value

The tool is most useful when someone claims that a portion of a document was not written by them — that it must have been altered after the document left their possession.

In that scenario, the individual should first be asked to identify which text they typed and which text they say was typed by someone else. Using this tool, an investigator can then locate the disputed text, colorize its associated rsidR value, and observe one of two outcomes:

- **Only the disputed text is colored** — consistent with that text having been added in a separate, isolated editing session.
- **The disputed text is colored together with text the individual acknowledged writing** — this indicates both were typed in the same session, which contradicts the individual's account and warrants soliciting an explanation for the discrepancy.

WARNING

This tool can assist with the analysis described above, but you should not rely purely on its output. Always validate findings by examining the underlying XML directly in word/document.xml inside the .docx package.

RSID-based attribution is corroborative, not conclusive, and the tool's rendering is a convenience layer over the raw evidence — not a substitute for it.

2. Recommended Workflow

The most efficient approach is **report first, colorize second**. Generating a report before applying any colors lets you review exactly which text is associated with which rsidR value, so you can make targeted choices instead of guessing.

TIP

Applying color to random rsidR values until the text you care about happens to light up is slow and error-prone.

The report tells you in advance which rsidR value maps to the text of interest, so you can go straight to colorizing the right one(s).

Workflow at a Glance

1. Open the document in the application.
2. Generate an RSID report and review which text segments belong to which rsidR value.
3. Return to the application and colorize the rsidR value(s) the report identified as relevant.
4. Save a colorized version to a new document (a log file is produced automatically).
5. Validate your findings against the raw word/document.xml.

3. The Application Interface

3.1 Opening a Document

Use **Open Document** on the ribbon to select a .docx file. When the document loads, the application:

- Computes and displays the file's MD5 hash in the file strip.
- Writes an **examination log** alongside the source file, recording the file's hashes, document metadata, and the full table of rsidR values discovered.

3.2 The rsidR Values Pane (Left Side)

The left pane lists every active rsidR value found in the document in a scrollable menu. For each value you will see:

- The **rsidR value** itself.
- A **count** of how many times that value appears in the document.

The list is **sorted in descending order by count**, so the rsidR value that appears most frequently is listed first. If there are more values than fit in the pane, scroll (mouse wheel or the scrollbar) to see the rest.

3.3 The Document Preview (Right Side)

The right pane shows the document's text. As you assign colors, the corresponding text updates immediately so you can see the effect before saving.

4. Colorizing rsidR Values

4.1 Applying Color

Click a value's color swatch (or its label) in the left pane to open a color picker and choose a color. You can colorize **one or more** rsidR values in a single document — assign different colors to different values to compare multiple editing sessions at once.

- **Clear All** removes every color assignment.
- **Reset** (on each row) removes the color from that single value.

4.2 Producing Multiple Colorized Versions

You can produce **as many different colorized versions of a document as you like**, using any combination of rsidR values. Each save is an independent output, so you might, for example, create one version highlighting a single disputed session and another comparing several sessions side by side.

⚠ WARNING

An rsidR value will only colorize text that was typed in that session.

If a particular editing session consisted only of formatting changes (e.g., bolding existing text or adjusting spacing) and no new text was typed, then selecting that rsidR value will produce no colored text — even though the value legitimately appears in the document and shows a non-zero count.

This is expected behavior, not a malfunction.

5. Saving and Logs

5.1 Saving a Colorized Document

Use **Save** or **Save As...** to write the colorized version to a **new document**. The original file is not modified.

⚠ WARNING

A colorized version will not retain all of the formatting of the original document.

The purpose of this tool is to identify text from different editing sessions — not to produce a faithful reproduction of the original's layout and styling.

Treat colorized outputs as analytical work product, not as substitutes for the original evidence.

5.2 The Colorization Log

Each time you save, an associated **log file** is created automatically. Among other things, it records:

- The source and output file names, sizes, and hashes (SHA-256 and MD5).
- The original document's metadata.
- The **rsidR values that were colorized and the associated color code** (hex and RGB) for each.

- A summary of how many values were colorized and how many runs were affected.

These logs support the integrity and reproducibility of your examination and should be retained with your case materials.

6. Generating an RSID Report

Use **Generate Report** to produce a Word document that maps rsidR values to the actual text associated with them. For each active rsidR value, the report lists the page number, paragraph number, and the extracted text segments tied to that value.

This report is the foundation of the recommended report-first workflow: review it to determine which rsidR value carries the text you're interested in, then return to the application and colorize precisely those values.

NOTE

Page-number mapping in the report relies on Microsoft Word automation.

If Word is unavailable on the system, the report will still be produced, but page numbers may not be populated.

7. Best Practices & Limitations

- **Report before colorizing.** It's faster and more defensible than trial and error.
- **Colorize purposefully.** Decide which sessions you're testing a hypothesis about, then color those values.
- **Expect empty results for formatting-only sessions.** A non-zero count does not guarantee colored text.
- **Don't treat colorized output as a formatted copy of the original.** Formatting is intentionally not preserved.
- **Always corroborate with the raw XML.** Open word/document.xml and confirm what the tool shows you. The colorizer is an aid to analysis, not the final word on it.
- **Retain the logs.** The examination and colorization logs document your process and the file hashes at each step.